

Week 8 Cram Sheet

Night-Before Recall + Quick Reference

Lecture 8 · Daniel Schrier, D.O.M., L.Ac. · Topic: Diagnosis by Hearing & Smelling — 聞診 (Wén Zhén)

Study Order — 1) Voice/Zang-Fu 2) Full/Empty voice & breathing 3) Cough/sneeze/reflexive sounds 4) Five Element Sounds 5) Six Healing Sounds 6) Smelling framework 7) Five Odors 8) Secretion odors.

1 · Framework

Component	Covers
Hearing	Voice, breathing, cough, vomiting, hiccup, borborygmi, sighing, belching
Smelling	Body odor + odor of secretions (breath, sweat, sputum, urine/stool, vaginal discharge, gas)

Quick Recall: 聞診 = Hearing + Smelling, 2nd of Four Pillars (望聞問切).

2 · Voice & Zang-Fu

Organ	Governs
Lung	Production of sound
Kidney	Volume of the voice
Spleen & Stomach	Strength of the voice

3 · Voice Patterns

Vocalization	Pattern
Loud voice	Full/Heat
Weak voice	Empty/Cold
Weak & vague	Ext. wind-cold, or Damp
Reluctance to talk	Cold, or Lung-Qi def.
Excessive talking	Heat
Sudden loss of voice	Wind-Heat invasion
Gradual loss of voice	Lung-Qi/Yin deficiency

Hoarseness Onset	Pattern
Sudden, low pitch, raspy	Exterior syndrome
Chronic, gradual intensity	Blood stagnation
Plum-pit sensation + cough	Phlegm-Heat
Chronic, worse in evening	Lung & Kidney Yin def.

Quick Recall: Loud/excessive=Full-Heat. Weak/reluctant=Empty-Cold. Worse-evening=Yin deficiency.

4 · Breathing & Respiration

Presentation	Pattern
Coarse, loud	Full
Weak, thin	Empty
Deep breathing	Excess qi in Heart/Lung
Weak breathing	Deficiency in Liver/Kidney

Feature	Excess/Heat	Empty/Cold
Sound	Loud	Low
Breath	Rough, distressed	Faint, slow
Onset	Acute	Slow

Panting: nostrils move, mouth open, shoulders raised, can't lie down. Excess=chest full/loud/rough (xie qi obstructing Lung). Deficiency=timid breath/low voice/worse with movement (Kidney can't absorb qi, or Lung can't govern qi).

Abnormal Type	Mechanism
Asthma	Lung qi failure to descend
Wheezing	Lung qi + phlegm obstruction
Upper Stifling	Lung qi rises, obstructs air tract
Shortness of Breath	Lung qi def. or Water Retention in Chest
Shortage of Qi	Lung qi obstructed/deficient, Zheng qi insufficient

5 · Cough, Sneeze & Reflexive Sounds

Presentation	Pattern
Loud, explosive cough	Full
Weak cough	Empty
Dry cough	Lung-Yin deficiency
No phlegm sound / phlegm w/ sound	"Unproductive" / "Productive" cough

Sneeze	Pattern
Acute, constant, loud	Heat/excess
Chronic, frequent, soft	Lung deficiency
Sudden, in critical chronic illness	Yang qi recovery
External stimulation	Normal

Symptom	Root	Deficiency/Cold	Excess/Heat
Vomiting	Rebellious ST Qi	Slow, low, faint, no force	Sudden, loud, forceful
Belching		Short, low sound	Loud, long sound
Hiccup		Quiet, low	Loud

Quick Recall: Vomiting/belching/hiccup all = Rebellious ST Qi. Loud/forceful=Excess-Heat or LV invading ST.

Borborygmi	Pattern
Loud	Full (Cold/Phlegm–damp MB, LR/SP disharmony, Damp–Heat ST&Int.)
Low	Empty (SP/KI yang def., MB qi def.)

Yawning	Pattern
Frequent, loud, emotion–triggered	Liver Qi Stagnation
+ Chest pain, after injury/chronic illness	Blood & Qi Stagnation
Infrequent, weak/no sound	SP/KI Yang deficiency

Sighing: LV or Lung Qi stagnation. LV=repressed anger/frustration. Lung=worry & sadness. Weak sound alt. root=SP/HT deficiency (sadness/grief/pensiveness).

6 • Five Element Sounds 五音

Element	Sound	Pinyin
Wood	Shout	Hū 呼
Fire	Laugh	Xiào 笑
Earth	Sing	Chàng 唱
Metal	Weep	—
Water	Groan	—

Quick Recall: Shout–Wood, Laugh–Fire, Sing–Earth, Weep–Metal, Groan–Water.

7 • Six Healing Sounds

Sound	Organ	Effect (1–liner)
Xū 嘘	Liver	Removes heat, brightens eyes
Hē 呵	Heart	Expels heat, reduces fire
Hū 呼	Spleen	Drives out heat, strengthens SP
Sì 呬	Lung	Calms qi, moistens lungs
Chuī 吹	Kidney	Removes wind–cold, urges stagnant qi
Xī 嘻	Triple Burner	Clears heat/restlessness, emotions

Heads Up — Hū 呼 = both "Shout" (Wood voice sound) AND "Spleen" Healing Sound. Same hanzi, two different tables — don't conflate.

8 • Diagnosis by Smelling — Framework

Aspect	Tells You
Body odor itself	Pattern of disharmony AND constitutional type
Odor of secretions	Nature of the pattern of disharmony only

Quick Recall: General rule — strong/foul/rotten = Heat/Excess. Absent/fishy = Cold/Deficient.

Body Odor	Pattern
Goatish	Wind, damp, heat accumulation
Foul, stinking	Epidemic disease, or summer heat toxin
Foul, in armpit	Damp–heat accumulation

9 • The Five (Named) Odors

Odor	Descriptor
Rancid (Sōu 餿)	Fat no longer fresh, mown grass, unpleasant
Scorched	Burnt toast, dryer–warm clothes, scorched ironing
Fragrant (Xiāng 香)	Cloying, sickly sweet — NOT actually pleasant
Rotten (Làn 爛)	Rotting meat / garbage truck
Putrid (Fǔ 腐)	Rotting meat / stagnant pond / stale urine

Heads Up — These 5 odor slides do NOT explicitly label a Zang–Fu element per odor (unlike Five Element Sounds). "Scorched" slide reuses xiào 笑 (same hanzi as Laughing) — likely a copy/paste error; classical scorched is jiāo 焦. Confirm with Prof. Schrier; don't assume the classical Wood/Fire/Earth/Metal/Water pairing without confirming in class.

10 • Odor of Bodily Secretions

Secretion	Foul/Strong →	Fishy/Odorless →
Breath	ST Heat/food retention (sour=food retention; pungent=Damp–Heat SP/ST; rotten=Damp–Heat LI)	Fishy=Phlegm–Heat Lung
Sweat	Strong=Damp–Heat	Putrid=disease of Lung/Liver/Kidney
Sputum	Strong/rotten=Heat in Lung (Phlegm–Heat/Toxic Heat)	Fishy=Lung–Heat; No smell=Cold

Stool/Flatulence	Pattern
Extremely stinky diarrhea w/ pus or blood	Damp–Heat in Intestines
Sour + foul, indigestion	Food stagnation
Fishy, loose stools	Cold in SP/ST
Slight/odorless, emotional stress	Liver qi stagnation
Rancid + rotten eggs	Toxic Heat in Large Intestines
No odor, abnormal color/frequent gas	ST/LI qi deficiency

Urine	Pattern
Freq/urgent/burning, turbid yellow, foul	Damp–Heat in Bladder
Heavy urea smell, scanty yellow	Heart fire → Bladder
Clear, frequent, odorless/slight fishy	Kidney deficiency
Odorless incontinence	Exhaustion of Kidney fire

Vaginal D/C & Other	Pattern
Strong, leathery	Damp–Heat
Fishy	Damp–Cold
Strong lochia post–childbirth	Damp–Heat/Toxic Heat in Uterus
Nose: yellow sticky, foul	Heat in Lung or Damp–Heat SP&ST
Ears: foul, fishy, turbid pus	Damp–Heat in ear
Eyes: red/swollen, foul fishy tears	Damp–Heat in Liver channel

Quick Recall: Across nearly every secretion — foul/strong/rotten=Heat/Damp–Heat; fishy/odorless=Cold/Deficiency.

Recognition Traps — Common Miscalls	
Trap	Correct Discriminator
"Fragrant" odor = pleasant	On these slides, Fragrant = cloying/sickly-sweet, NOT a pleasant finding
Hū 呼 always means "Shout"	Also the Spleen Healing Sound — check which table you're in
All 5 odors map cleanly to 5 Elements	Slides don't label element per odor; don't assume the classical pairing without confirming
Chronic hoarseness always = Blood stagnation	Chronic + worse in evening = Lung/Kidney Yin deficiency instead
Loud sound always = Excess	True for voice/cough/borborygmi/belching/yawning — but pair with onset & other signs before committing
Heads Up — Quiz Move: For every hearing/smelling finding: sound/odor quality → loud/foul vs. weak/faint → Full/Excess/Heat vs. Empty/Deficiency/Cold → organ → one confirming detail.	